

Ravi Menon

Director of Engineering • Distributed Systems & Platform Infrastructure
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Summary

Engineering leader with 14 years of experience building and scaling distributed systems, platform infrastructure, and high-availability services for consumer-scale applications. Proven track record leading engineering organizations of 30+ through hypergrowth, driving architectural strategy, and partnering cross-functionally with Product and Data Science leadership.

Key Achievements

- ★ Led platform migration reducing infrastructure costs by \$2.1M annually
- ★ Scaled engineering org from 8 to 34 engineers across 3 years
- ✓ Reduced P0 incident rate by 65% through observability overhaul
- ✓ Built the company's first multi-region failover architecture

Experience

Director of Engineering — Northbeam Systems, Seattle, WA

April 2021 – Present

- Lead a 34-person engineering organization spanning platform, infrastructure, and reliability engineering teams
- Drove the migration from a monolithic architecture to a service-oriented platform, reducing deployment time from 45 minutes to 4 minutes
- Partnered with the CTO to define a 3-year technical roadmap aligned to company growth targets
- Established an SRE practice from scratch, implementing SLOs across all customer-facing services
- Reduced annual cloud infrastructure spend by \$2.1M through a combination of right-sizing, reserved capacity planning, and architectural consolidation
- Hired and mentored 6 engineering managers, building a leadership bench for continued scaling

Senior Engineering Manager — Coalmont Digital, Seattle, WA

January 2018 – March 2021

- Managed 3 engineering teams (18 engineers) responsible for the company's core transaction processing platform
- Led the design and rollout of a multi-region failover architecture, achieving 99.99% uptime SLA
- Implemented a company-wide observability initiative (distributed tracing, structured logging, on-call tooling), reducing mean-time-to-resolution by 40%
- Collaborated with Data Science leadership to build a real-time feature store supporting fraud detection models
- Ran quarterly technical planning cycles across 3 teams, aligning roadmaps to business OKRs

Engineering Manager — Coalmont Digital, Seattle, WA

June 2015 – December 2017

- Managed a team of 7 backend engineers building the company's payments infrastructure
- Led the transition from a single-region deployment to an active-active multi-region setup
- Introduced a formal incident review process, reducing repeat incidents by 30% year over year
- Owned vendor evaluation and migration for the company's core message queue infrastructure (moved from RabbitMQ to Kafka)

Senior Software Engineer — Coalmont Digital, Seattle, WA

August 2013 – May 2015

- Built core backend services for the company's payments platform using Java and PostgreSQL
- Designed and implemented a rate-limiting and fraud-scoring service handling 50M+ requests/day
- Mentored 3 junior engineers and led the team's on-call rotation redesign

Software Engineer — Pinehollow Technologies, Portland, OR

July 2011 – July 2013

- Developed internal tooling for a mid-sized e-commerce platform using Python and Django
- Built automated testing infrastructure that reduced regression bugs in production by 25%
- Participated in a full re-platforming effort migrating from a legacy PHP codebase to Django

Junior Developer — Pinehollow Technologies, Portland, OR

June 2010 – June 2011

- Supported maintenance and bug fixes for the company's internal inventory management system
- Wrote unit and integration tests to improve coverage on legacy modules

Education

M.S. Computer Science — University of Washington, Seattle, WA

Graduated 2010

B.S. Computer Engineering — Oregon State University, Corvallis, OR

Graduated 2008

Skills

Distributed Systems, Kafka, Kubernetes, AWS, GCP, PostgreSQL, Java, Python, Go, Site Reliability Engineering, System Design, Engineering Leadership, Observability (Datadog, Prometheus), Terraform, Microservices Architecture, Incident Management, Team Building